

Between the Lines — Paper C

HARD • 35 MINUTES • 25 MARKS

NAME

DATE

SCORE / 25

- Answer **every** question in the space provided.
- Read **both** texts once, properly, before you answer anything. The last two questions need both.
- Answer only from the lines the question names. A perfect answer from the wrong lines scores nothing.
- When a question asks for **two things**, give two separate ideas. One idea written twice is one mark.
- Pay attention to punctuation and spelling. The number of marks is shown in brackets [] on the right.
- One of the two texts on this paper is not a story. You have not been taught that text type — apply the ideas you already have.
- No framework is printed on this paper. Remembering the three rungs is part of what it is testing.

Text A — Ananya is thirteen. Her mother entered her for the district swimming trial in February; it is now April, and Ananya is standing behind block four.

3 Behind block four the tiles are cold and slightly wet and Ananya has been standing on
4 the same two of them for six minutes. She has not looked at the water. She has looked
5 at the clock, at the roof, at the line of parents along the glass, and at her own
6 feet, which is where she is looking now.

7 Her mother filled in the form in February. Ananya found out in February too, from her
8 mother, who said it the way you say a thing that has already been done: brightly, and
9 while doing something else.

10 There is a version of this morning in which she swims badly. She has thought about it
11 in some detail. Not falling in, nothing dramatic — just an ordinary fourth place, the
12 kind nobody asks about in the car. It would take about forty seconds and it would
13 settle the question of next year.

14 The girl in block three is doing something complicated with her shoulders. Somebody's
15 father shouts a name that is not anyone's name here. The air smells of chlorine and
16 of the inside of a bag.

17 'Take your marks.'

18 Here is the thing Ananya has not told anyone, including herself, in any sentence that
19 used actual words: she likes the first four strokes. Not the racing. The four strokes
20 after the water closes over, when it is quiet and nobody is anything.

21 The starter goes.

22 She does not decide to swim well. Her arms decide, somewhere around the fifteen-metre

23 mark, and by the turn she is second, and coming off the wall she is first, and the
 24 last ten metres are the loudest silence she has ever been in.

25 She touches. She hangs on the lane rope with her chest going and looks up at the
 26 board, which says her name, and then along the glass at her mother, who is already
 27 turning to the woman beside her to say something.

28 Ananya puts her face back in the water, which is the only place nobody can see it.

Text B — From a blog kept by a swimming coach who has run district trials for eleven years.

30 Every February I get the same email. 'I have entered my daughter. She doesn't know yet.'

31 I want to be careful here, because the parents who write that email are not villains.

32 They are usually right about the talent. That is the difficult part: if they were
 33 wrong, the problem would solve itself in April.

34 What they are wrong about is the order. A child who is entered for a thing and then
 35 told about it has been given the result of a decision and no part in making it. At
 36 thirteen, that child has one way left to have an opinion, and it is not a good one:
 37 to swim slowly enough that nobody enters her again.

38 I have watched perhaps two hundred children do this. It is very hard to spot, because
 39 it looks exactly like a bad day.

40 My advice is always the same and it is almost never taken. Ask her in January. Accept
 41 the answer. If the answer is no, you have lost one season, and if the answer is yes,
 42 you have gained a swimmer instead of a passenger.

SECTION A – READING

1. Look at lines 3-10.

(a) Give **two** things that tell the reader Ananya does not want to be at the trial. [2]

(b) What does *brightly, and while doing something else* suggest about how her mother told her? Tick (✓) **one** box. [1]

She was in a hurry that morning

She presented it as settled, so that it could not be argued with

She was genuinely delighted for her daughter

She had forgotten to mention it earlier

2. Look at **lines 10-13**.

(a) Give the **three-word phrase** that describes the result Ananya has in mind. [1]

(b) Give **one word** that means 'to decide something finally'. [1]

3. Look at **lines 18-20**. Ananya has avoided admitting something to herself. Give **two** things in the writing that show this. [2]

SECTION B – QUOTATION AND EXPLANATION

4. Look at **lines 22-28**. Which of these opinions do you agree with most? Tick (✓) **one** box, then give **two** quotations that support the opinion you chose, and explain how each one supports it.

Ananya is pleased to have won, but cannot show it in front of her mother.

Ananya has won the race she meant to lose, and does not yet know what she feels.

Quotation 1 [1]

Explanation 1 [1]

Quotation 2 [1]

Explanation 2 [1]

5. Look at **Text B (lines 30-42)**. The coach is careful to be fair to the parents he disagrees with. Give **two** quotations that show this, and explain how each one does.

Quotation 1

[1]

Explanation 1

[1]

Quotation 2

[1]

Explanation 2

[1]

SECTION C – THE WHOLE TEXT

6. Look at **lines 36-42**.

(a) Give **one word** that means ‘a person who is carried along without taking any part’. [1]

(b) What does *and it is not a good one* tell the reader about the coach’s attitude to a child who swims slowly on purpose? [1]

7. What does *It is very hard to spot, because it looks exactly like a bad day* (lines 38-39) mean? Tick (✓) **one** box. [1]

Children often swim badly for no particular reason

A deliberately slow swim cannot be told apart from a genuine one

The coach cannot watch every lane at once

Weather and illness affect times more than people think

8. Look at **Text B**. What features tell the reader that this text is written to persuade rather than to tell a story? Give **two** features. [2]

9. Look at the **whole text**.

(a) Text B says that such a child *has one way left to have an opinion*. Give **one** phrase from Text A showing Ananya considering exactly that, and **one** showing why she did not do it in the end. [2]

(b) Put these events into chronological order, numbering them from first (1) to last (5). **One** example has been done for you. [3]

Event	Order of events
Her mother fills in the entry form	1
Ananya plans an ordinary fourth place	
Ananya looks along the glass at her mother	
Ananya is told she has been entered	
The starter goes	

End of paper. Before you hand it in, check every explanation names a word from inside your own quotation. That is the mark most often left behind on a paper like this.